



YOU ARE **15 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

170 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Here the baby is seen within the amniotic sac. For the first time, her head is smaller than her body, marking another developmental milestone. Having a large, heavy head is not a problem in the nearly weightless environment of the uterus.

“Your doctor may speak to you about writing a birth plan so she can get an idea of the type of labor and birth you want.”

The purpose of a birth plan is to communicate your wishes for labor and birth to those who are caring for you. Writing a plan will help you to address different aspects of the labor, such as methods of pain relief and who you'd like to attend the birth. It also gives you a chance to ask questions about procedures such as induction and other types of medical intervention. Filling in a plan is also a useful way for your birth partner to be made aware of your wishes so that he or she can communicate these to the doctor while you're in labor.

Bear in mind that circumstances may dictate that not all of your preferences are met, but there's more chance of you getting the labor and birth you want if you've thought it through and written down your views. Being as informed as possible about labor and your choices (see [Planning for your birth](#)) will help you to prepare in advance.

YOUR BIRTH PLAN

Scented candles, womb music, and beanbags... or serious pain relief from the first contraction? Writing a birth plan is an opportunity for you to think about how you'd like your labor and delivery to go. Give it some thought now and if there are parts of the plan you are unsure about, begin discussing this with your midwife

- **Start to think about:** your birth partner(s), pain-relief preferences, whether you'd like an active labor, and the environment you'd prefer to give birth in. You might know you want to give birth in the hospital or at home, or in a birth center, which offers a home-style setting with the backup of medical technology.
- **Consider your options**—for example, you might want to use a birthing pool or give birth in an upright position. You might want minimal medical intervention.
- **Be flexible** because labor doesn't always go according to plan and your baby's safe delivery is the most important thing.